

Get Good Advice

ONE OF THE smartest things I ever did was build a team of professionals around me to advise on complex matters beyond my skill set and experience. Unfortunately, I did not figure this out until I was middle-aged. You should not wait as long as I did.

You need a good lawyer and business counselor. They can provide not just legal advice but smart counsel. (They have seen similar problems before.) An experienced accountant and tax professional can save you thousands. Your doctor should be a general practitioner (GP) who can also advise and refer on any medical issue.

And for many people, having a financial planner and advisor can be extremely useful.

Do you need a financial advisor? *Maybe*. Understanding your circumstances will help you decide what sort of financial services you want to pay for. But before we work through this, a pre-emptive counterargument.

Hey Ritholtz, doesn't your firm sell financial services? Are we getting objective advice here?

Fair question: As I buried earlier in a footnote, my firm has an unusual business model. Since the early 2000s, I have been giving away very useful advice to people on how to manage their assets themselves. You only need a little bit of savvy, a few minutes each month, and some self-discipline to be a good investor. That's been my core message, shared at The Big Picture, on my Bloomberg podcasts, and in my *Washington Post* and Bloomberg columns. The rest of the RWM crew does the same—on Substacks and Beehives, in books, on YouTube, TV, radio, and in blog posts.

Our business model—you *don't need to pay us a fee; you can do this on your own*—is not only rare on Wall Street but also very counterintuitive.